

A-List Reviews

A listing of the best products in different hardware and software categories

Every Digit reader must surely be aware of the various comparison tests we do at our Digital Test and Research Centre. The comparison includes various products from all categories. They range from motherboards to keyboards, and other cool gadgets such as digital cameras and MP3 players. We grade these products based on their performance, features and their

merit as per the money you pay for it. The 'A' listed products are those which are truly the best among the best. What we are giving here are products, that you can safely bet on. When you buy one such product you can be absolutely sure that it will perform up to the mark you expect. Read on to find out more about the product you have been hunting for all this time.

CPU

Intel Pentium 4 3.06 GHz

HyperThreading finally becomes a reality for the desktop PC with Intel's Pentium 4 3.06 GHz processor, which truly impresses with its performance.



This is as fast as you can get!

Pentium IV 3.06 GHz B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: 3.06 GHz clock speed, 512 KB on chip cache, Northwood (0.13 micron)
Price: Rs 37,000 **Contact:** Nebula Technologies
Phone: 044-22323715 **Email:** pratik@nebulatech.com
Web site: www.intel.com

AMD XP 1700+

The AMD Athlon XP 1700+ takes the crown for the best value processor. As far as performance goes, this one delivers on all fronts. It was able to beat all its competitors with its price to performance ratio.

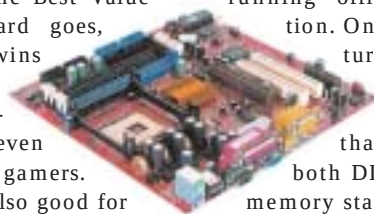
AMD XP 1700+ B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: 256 KB L2 cache, 133 MHz FSB, Thoroughbred core
Price: Rs 4,250 **Contact:** AMD Far East Ltd **Phone:** 011-26238620
E-mail: amd@surggold.com **Web site:** www.amd.com

MOTHERBOARD

Mercury KOB650GL NDSMx

As far as the Best Value motherboard goes, this product wins hands down; it is an outstanding buy even for hardcore gamers. The board is also good for



running office application. One of the features you may find handy is that it supports both DDR and SDR memory standards. The

board features onboard graphics but does not leave out the AGP 4X port either. Overall, its low price makes it a great buy.

Mercury KOB650GL NDSMx B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: SiS650 chipset, DDR and SDRAM support, onboard sound, onboard Ethernet, 4X AGP, 2 PCI slots, native USB 2.0 support
Price: Rs 3,300 **Contact:** Kobian India Ltd **Phone:** 080-5566626
E-mail: rohit@kobian.com **Web site:** www.kobian.com

MSI 845PE Max2

This motherboard features a DDR 333 solution based on Intel's latest 845PE chipset, which supports Intel's HyperThreading technology. It's a nice little board that provides great features and good speeds to boot.

MSI 845PE Max2 B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: 845 PE chipset with HyperThreading technology, DDR 333 support, onboard AC'97 5.1 channel support, IEEE 1394, Gigabit Ethernet, Promise RAID controller, 4X AGP, 6 PCI slots, 1 CNR slot, USB 2.0 module
Price: Rs 9,000 **Contact:** Priya Ltd **Phone:** 022-22663611
E-mail: salesbom@priyagroup.com **Web site:** www.priyagroup.com

MSI KT4 Ultra

This latest motherboard from MSI is built around the KT400 chipset for the fastest AMD processors. The Athlon XP, when paired with this motherboard, zooms past the Pentium 4 2.8 GHz. It's recommended for performance enthusiasts.

MSI KT4 Ultra B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: KT400 Northbridge, VT8235 Southbridge, Bus Speed: 200/266MHz, Memory Support 3 184-pin DDR SDRAMs (Up to 3GB), 6-PCI bus slots (support 3.3v/5v PCI bus interface), 6 USB 2.0 ports (4 Rear/ 2 Front), Serial ATA Interface (Optional)
Price: Rs 7,850 **Contact:** Priya Ltd **Phone:** 022-22663611
E-Mail: salesbom@priyagroup.com **Web site:** www.msi.com.tw